Prepared for BlackRock

Aladdin Studio, learned with AI

What public sources show about Studio, where BlackRock is heading, and the likely initial directions for marketing it

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Independent analysis from public sources with AI agents. Not produced, reviewed or endorsed by BlackRock.

Executive summary

Studio is the product behind the growth story BlackRock tells investors, but the story never names it. Public proof that clients use Aladdin never names Studio either. Part 3 sets out six directions to close both gaps.

17x

Projected growth in API calls by 2030, the fastest-growing measure on BlackRock's 2025 Investor Day slide

$25.6M

JPMorgan Chase's 2025 payments to BlackRock for Aladdin, per its proxy statement, almost 6x its 2017 level

0

Mentions of Studio by a BlackRock executive on 26 earnings calls, Q1 2020 to Q2 2026

Sources, left to right: BlackRock 2025 Investor Day[1], slide on keeping the cost of growth low: API calls 17x, model portfolios 4x, portfolios 2x, trade allocations 1.3x. The slide does not say which products generate the API calls; attributing them to Studio is my inference. JPMorgan Chase proxy statements[2, 3]. Third-party earnings call transcripts[4].

Studio is Aladdin's developer and data layer, with three parts: APIs and events, a Python SDK and Aladdin Data Cloud on Snowflake. Five BlackRock speakers have defined it on the record since 2024[5]. Public documents prove named clients use Aladdin (none names Studio): JPMorgan Chase's proxy statements, Janus Henderson's commits and 10-K, Royal London's chief executive on video, and three pension tenders.

API calls are the fastest-growing measure BlackRock showed investors: 17x by 2030. The other half of the growth story is the whole portfolio, public markets and private; the new private-markets data arrives through Data Cloud and Explore[6]. Aladdin Copilot, BlackRock's AI assistant, works only inside the Aladdin login, while data providers offer connectors that let outside AI tools pull their data[7]. Buyers at BlackRock's own webinar want a core platform plus tools they build themselves, and rivals already sell to that demand[8].

Six likely initial directions, in the order I would take them; none changes how Aladdin is sold:

1. Collect named client proof, starting with clients whose Aladdin relationship is already public.
2. Put Studio's name beside the 17x API-call projection in investor and client materials.
3. Write the one-page definition of Studio that four speakers so far give only in recordings.
4. Prepare an RFP-ready answer to the question buyers now ask: what is your API suite?
5. Describe the Copilot plugin model publicly: API mapping, governance, client AI-tool connections.
6. Write a prospect-facing "what is in the box" summary of the public API catalog.

What this method can and cannot do

Public material only. BlackRock web pages, the 54 API specifications inside 11 public `asdk_plugin` Python packages, 128 recordings, SEC filings, procurement notices, GitHub and PyPI. AI agents pulled them in about a day; I checked every fact against its document. Some recordings are machine-transcribed, so names and jargon can be misheard; the Sources section marks which recordings. Figures may be out of date, and I have no internal product context, so some conclusions may be wrong for reasons I cannot see.

How to read the receipts

Underlined text links to the document behind the fact. Each superscript number points to an entry in Sources, at the end of this document, giving the grade (P, S or T), title, speaker and date. For recordings it also gives the minute and second where each quoted passage begins.

■ **P** Primary document: a filing, a specification, a web page or press release, a procurement notice, or code on GitHub or PyPI

■ **S** BlackRock speaker on the record, with the name and title as the recording gives them

□ **T** Third-party report: trade press, or a third party's summary of a primary source

Part 1

What the public record shows

Aladdin is the investment platform BlackRock built for itself and sells to other institutions. Brennan Rosales, its AI Engineering Lead, put the scale this way at a LangChain conference in 2025. "BlackRock is the biggest user of Aladdin, but we also sell and support hundreds of clients globally across 70 countries." The organization is "around 7,000 people, with over 4,000 of those being engineers." They maintain "around 100 Aladdin front-end applications"[9]. BlackRock's technology services and subscription revenue was $2.0 billion in 2025, up 24 percent with Preqin[10]. BlackRock sells the platform as one engine with separate entry points, and Studio is the entry point for people who write code. Aladdin is sold the way enterprise platforms are sold: the conversation comes first, and documentation, a sandbox and credentials come from the solutions team once a prospect is qualified. Part 1 covers what a prospect can see before that conversation.

Exhibit 1. BlackRock sells one engine through eight named products, and Studio is the entry point for people who write code

Product	What it does	Main users
Aladdin	The front-to-back system for public markets, the same system BlackRock runs internally[9]	Asset managers, insurers, pension funds, banks
Aladdin Wealth	Portfolio risk analysis and proposals for advisors. Its AI "auto commentary" tool launched in October 2025, with Morgan Stanley as the first client[11]	Wealth managers and private banks
eFront	A private-fund investment platform covering due diligence through cash flows and reporting; Preqin was folded into eFront Insight, with private credit analytics added in May 2026[12]	Investors in funds and fund managers
Aladdin Studio	**The developer and data layer. It covers APIs and events, a Python SDK, Aladdin Compute and Aladdin Data Cloud. BlackRock calls it "API-first" and names three users: "a professional engineer building new workflow applications, a code-curious portfolio manager extracting investment insights, or a data analyst automating reporting"[13]**	**Client engineers, data analysts, code-curious portfolio managers**
Aladdin Data Cloud	A managed data service on Snowflake that puts Aladdin and outside data in one place. It is sold as an add-on to Aladdin Enterprise[14]. Richard Newman, General Manager, Aladdin Studio, calls it "part of Studio"[15]	Data teams
Aladdin Copilot	A chat assistant "now available to all Aladdin clients" that "will not give investment advice"[16]	All platform users
Aladdin Accounting	Investment accounting and performance; the public accounting APIs cover configuration, valuations, lots and composites[17]	Asset managers and asset owners
Aladdin Provider	Connects custodians and administrators into a client's Aladdin; service providers pay BlackRock for its use[18]	Custodians and administrators

Source: BlackRock product pages[13, 16, 19]; Amazon press release, December 2025[14]; iShares prospectus[18]; the public specifications[17].

BlackRock's own definition of Studio comes from the head of Studio engineering, on Snowflake's podcast in November 2025. It has three parts.

> "So we think about Aladdin today as a platform and Aladdin Studio is essentially the user experience that allows people to think of Aladdin as a platform. It exposes everything Aladdin knows how to do as a set of APIs events. The Aladdin data cloud built on top of Snowflake takes all of that information that's generated through our analytics factory and inside of Aladdin and pushes that into Snowflake. And increasingly we're building a set of developer tools."
>
> — Dave Woodhead, Managing Director and Head of Engineering for Aladdin Studio, Snowflake Data Cloud podcast, published November 11, 2025[5]

The three parts are APIs and events, the Aladdin Data Cloud on Snowflake, and developer tools. Exhibit 2 follows one trade through Aladdin, as far as the public specifications describe it. For each step it records who acts, which product or application BlackRock names, and which of the 54 public API specifications covers the step[17, 20].

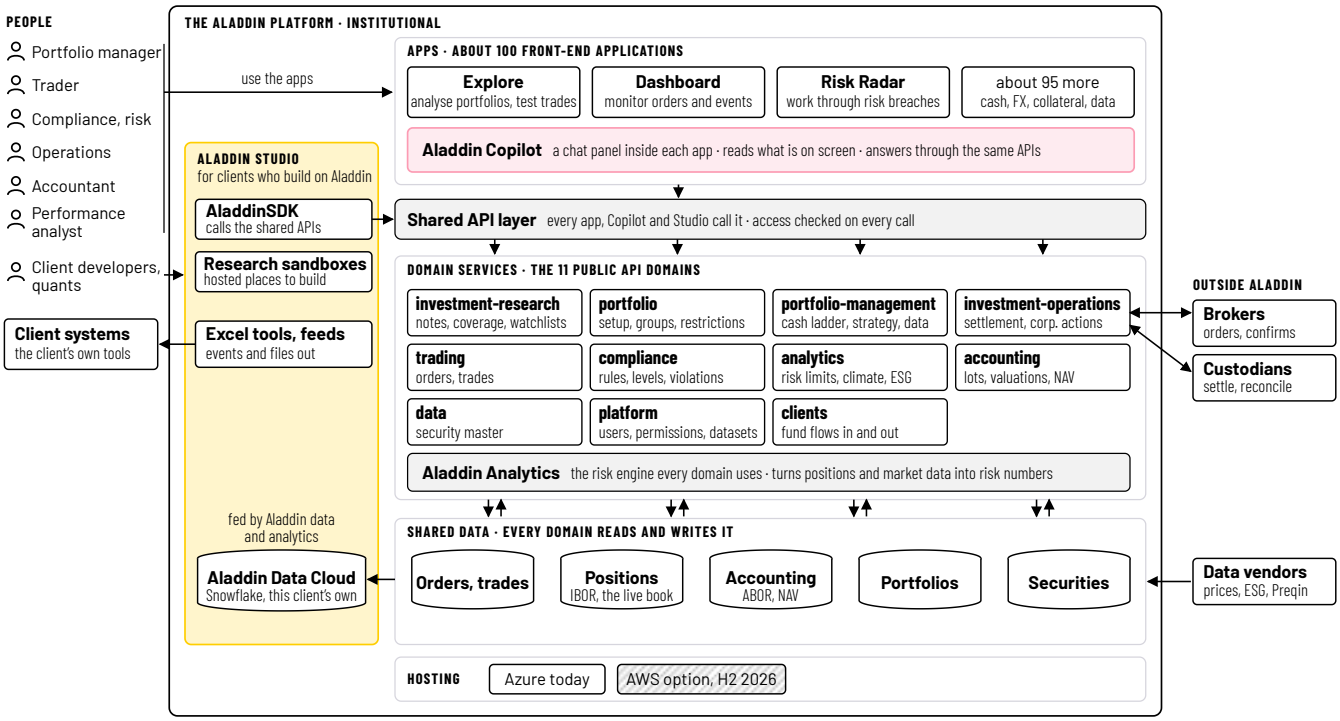
Exhibit 2. The public APIs trace a trade from order to NAV, but they name no order screen and hold no position or event API

Step	Who acts	Named product or application	Public API that covers it
1 **Order**	The portfolio manager: an order is "a directive from a portfolio manager to the trading desk to execute a particular investment decision"[17]	The Explore application: its "new what-if model" compares a changed portfolio with the original before anything is traded[21]. The specifications name no order screen[17]	`OrderAPI` v1 (stable). Posting an order takes `whatIf` and `runCompliance`. The specification's example statuses run "Open," "Compl Pending," "Authorized," "Active," "Booked"[17]
2 **Compliance check**	No one. The check runs automatically when the order is posted, because `runCompliance` is on by default. Any violation then carries an owner, a disposition and a resolution comment[17]	Rules "automatically monitor whether a fund adheres to a regulation, client mandate, or internal guideline"; no application is named[17]	`ComplianceRuleAPI` and `ViolationAPI` v1 (alpha). Violations are "generated at time of the compliance breach," intraday and overnight. A check that times out posts the order as "Compl Pending"[17]
3 **Trade**	The trading desk; operations then confirms, since "after a trade is booked in Aladdin, it needs to be confirmed with broker"[17]	The people who lead Aladdin Accounting say the run goes "from that first order through the trade, through all the operation protocols into accounting without lifting up the pencil"[20]	`TradeAPI` v2 (alpha), with `trades:post`, `batchPost` and `filter`. A block trade carries its per-portfolio trades, plus `confirmedWith` and `confirmedBy`. `BrokerConfirmRoutingAPI` routes the confirm[17]

Step	Who acts	Named product or application	Public API that covers it
4 **Position in the IBOR**	The investment team, whose live book is the IBOR, the investment book of record. Newman: "It does start with IBOR"[15]	Aladdin Data Cloud, where users "can access their Investment Books of Record (IBOR), Accounting Books of Record (ABOR) holdings"[22]	None of the 54 is a position API. Positions appear only as fields: a positions source in `PortfolioToolkitAPI`, and a violation's "underlying positions." `CashLadderAPI` v2 (stable) gives the settlement-date cash ladder[17]
5 **Lot in the ABOR**	The accounting team, which says of itself: "we are data managers more than anything else"[20]	Aladdin Accounting. The public portfolio-configuration specification is written for this product[17]	`AborLotAPI` v1 (alpha). Lots in the ABOR, the accounting book of record, are "retrieved from the ledger_a_summary table," each with an `oborLotId` and open and close transaction ids. `EnrichedCapitalFlowAPI` v1 (stable) posts subscriptions and redemptions[17]
6 **NAV**	Accounting, whose clients are "CFOs, they're controllers, they're heads of performance"[20]	Aladdin Accounting; each valuation carries its own exception list[17]	`ValuationsAPI` v1, beta: valuations "generated for various processes at the portfolio/portfolio group level," with `navLogExceptionRecords` per valuation[17]

■ Source: the public specifications (trading, compliance, investment operations, portfolio, portfolio management, accounting, clients)[17]; Newman[15]; the Explore training recording[21]; the Aladdin Accounting episode[20]; Fivetran[22]. The statuses are the Order specification's examples. Alpha, beta, stable and sunset are the stability labels each specification carries (its `x-aladdin-api-stability` field), alpha being the earliest. The specifications hold no position or event API, and they do not say in what sequence steps 4 to 6 happen.

Exhibit 3. Every app, Copilot and Studio call one API layer, and the 11 public domains sit behind it



For illustrative purposes only. ■ Source: about 100 apps, with Copilot in all of them, Rosales and Vicente Valdez at 2:35[9]. The 11 domains are the packages of BlackRock's public SDK, named as in its specifications[17, 23]. App names other than Explore come from field descriptions in those specifications, so their screens are not drawn[17, 21]. Aladdin Analytics is the name the risk specifications give the engine[17]. Studio, Woodhead at 4:49[5]; Excel tools and feeds, the APIs page[24]; Data Cloud fed by Aladdin data and analytics[5, 19]; hosting[25, 14]. Solid outline = shown in sources; hatched = announced, not live.

Exhibit 4. Six pieces make up Studio, no event specification is public, and the catalog, guides, notebooks and samples all sit behind a client login

Piece	What it is, in plain words
APIs (Aladdin Graph)	Ways for a program to read and write Aladdin data. Aladdin Graph is the whole API layer, not one API: every public specification carries an id of the form `agraph.<domain>.<segment>.<group>.v1.<API>`[17]. The APIs page says there are "dozens," with more added regularly[24]. The 54 specifications include orders, trades, compliance rules, risk rules, security creation and Data Cloud datasets[17].
Event-driven APIs	Aladdin tells a program when something happens. Woodhead names "APIs events" as one part[5]; Diwakar Goel, Global Head of Data, Aladdin, wants "every single transaction … via an event, via an API"[26]. No event specification is in the public packages[17].
Aladdin Data Cloud	A managed data store on Snowflake, with Fivetran moving the data. Goel puts its latency at "within 15 minutes"[26]. Woodhead: "hundreds of Snowflake accounts … tens of thousands of pipelines"[5].
Aladdin Compute	A hosted space where developers run Python next to their Aladdin data; the SDK has a run mode for "Aladdin Studio Compute sessions"[23].
Aladdin SDK	An open-source Python library that handles login, retries, rate limits, pagination and long-running operations[23]. Eleven add-on packages, one per API domain, are generated from the specifications by BlackRock's plugin builder[27].
Developer Portal and Data Dictionary	The API catalog, framework guides, field dictionary, notebooks and code samples the APIs page describes. All sit behind a client login[24].

■ Source: BlackRock Studio and APIs pages[13, 24]; the 54 public specifications and SDK README[17, 23]; Woodhead[5] and Goel[26].

Exhibit 5. Investment operations and analytics hold 127 of the 301 public operations, and only 23 of the 54 specifications are stable

Domain	Specs	Operations	Alpha	Beta	Stable	Sunset	Largest APIs by operations
Investment operations	15	**74**	9	4	2	–	PrincipalInterestFactor, CounterPartySettlementInstruction, MiscellaneousCashflow, CouponReset and 11 more
Analytics	9	**53**	–	–	8	1	RiskRule, RiskWorkflow, RiskException, RiskConfig and 5 more
Investment research	5	**41**	5	–	–	–	AnalystCoverage, Criterion, Watchlist, ResearchNote and 1 more
Platform	6	**29**	2	–	4	–	AdcDataset, UserGroup, User, UserGroupPermission and 2 more
Portfolio management	4	**28**	1	–	3	–	CIDWriter, Strategy, CIDReader, CashLadder
Portfolio	3	**23**	1	–	2	–	PortfolioGroup, RestrictedAsset, PortfolioToolkit
Data	1	**15**	–	–	1	–	SecurityCreation
Trading	2	**14**	1	–	1	–	Order, Trade
Compliance	4	**9**	3	–	1	–	ComplianceRuleAssignment, Violation, ComplianceRule, Level
Accounting	4	**8**	2	2	–	–	PortfolioConfiguration, Valuations, CompositeMembership, AborLot
Clients	1	**7**	–	–	1	–	EnrichedCapitalFlow
Total	**54**	**301**	**24**	**6**	**23**	**1**	11 domains, 11 PyPI packages

■ Source: the 54 Swagger 2.0 specifications inside the 11 `asdk_plugin` packages, version 2.0.0b3, on PyPI[17]. Counts are mine, recomputed from the files. The core `aladdinsdk` package adds four utility APIs (token, subscription, notification and a demo), not counted here.

The specifications say more than their count. Every one is tagged `Access.Internal`, a label BlackRock does not explain in public[17]. Posting an order takes `whatIf` and `runCompliance`, which defaults to true, and the response returns any compliance violations inline[17]. Ten specifications expose an endpoint for long-running operations, 35 operations are flagged as long-running, and the SDK polls them[23]. Risk exceptions and Data Cloud datasets carry bitemporal fields, which record two time dimensions. Rule assignments and dataset releases name a four-eyes approval, a second sign-off[17]. Every request carries an application key plus OAuth 2.0 scopes such as `trading.order_management.order.v1.Order:read`, and the client ID and secret come from the Studio UI[23].

What is out there before a conversation starts

Exhibit 6 follows a prospect's engineer through six steps, from first hearing about Studio to getting help. For each step it records what is public today and what a client receives after qualification.

The SDK is the one piece that installs before any conversation. It has had 14 releases since May 2024, all alpha or beta. The core is at 2.0.0b10 as of July 2026 and the add-ons at 2.0.0b3[28, 17]. Each release pins an old Snowflake library, so none installs on Python 3.13. The SDK's dependencies also conflict with the official MCP toolkit. (MCP, the Model Context Protocol, is the standard AI assistants use to pull data from other systems.) An outside contributor's fix for the conflict was merged in August 2026 and has not shipped[29]. The README documents three run modes: "a developer's local machine," "Aladdin Studio Compute sessions" and a test mode. It stores a prompted password in the operating system's credential manager. It carries settings for firms that consume "the Aladdin APIs via an enterprise API management platform such as Azure API Management"[23]. Run modes, credential storage and API-gateway settings are the needs of a client's engineering team.

Exhibit 6. A prospect's developer can hear about Studio, read the pages and unpack the catalog, but cannot run anything until qualified

Step	Out there today	After qualification	Receipt
Hear	Podcasts, webinar replays, client videos and conference talks on BlackRock's site and partner channels	Client forums and the solutions team	Never Done[30], Big Little Questions[31], Woodhead[5], Rosales and Valdez[9]
Read	The Studio page, which says "Create & automate," "Make Aladdin your own" and "Align internally & externally"; the APIs page, which promises "dozens of APIs"	The Developer Portal and the API framework guides	Studio page[13], APIs page[24]
See the catalog	The 54 specifications, but only by unpacking the 11 PyPI add-on packages	The API catalog and the Data Dictionary	asdk_plugin packages[17], APIs page[24]
Try	Nothing to run: no public sandbox or trial is offered	Studio Compute; an API token or an OAuth application "registered via Studio UI"; and the client's own Aladdin host to call	SDK README[23]
Build	The open-source SDK on GitHub and PyPI, with a detailed README; the plugin builder	A client host and credentials, which the SDK needs for every call	SDK README[23], PyPI history[28], plugin builder[27]
Get help	GitHub issues and pull requests on the SDK, answered by BlackRock engineers; on the Studio page, "Book a meeting" and "Download the brochure"	Notebooks, code samples, support	Pull request 52[32], pull request 57[29], Studio page[13]

■ Source: the pages and repositories in the Receipt column, read with no account or login, October 2026. The After qualification column is what those sources say a client receives; I did not test it.

Exhibit 7. Two access models coexist: investment platforms, Studio among them, gate access until a relationship exists, while data and cloud platforms sell to developers directly

2: Fully public or self-serve 1: Partial or after sign-up or approval 0: None or blocked

Platform	Public docs	API catalog	Trial or sandbox	First call as a non-client	Sample code	Community or marketplace	AI connector	Call to action	Total
Investment platforms									
Bloomberg	1	0	1	1	1	0	0	1	**5**
Aladdin Studio	**1**	**1**	**0**	**0**	**1**	**1**	**0**	**0**	**4**
State Street	1	0	1	0	0	1	0	1	**4**
Arcesium	0	0	0	0	0	1	2	0	**3**
SimCorp	0	0	0	0	0	1	0	0	**1**
Clearwater	0	0	0	0	0	1	0	0	**1**
Data and cloud platforms									
Snowflake	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	**16**
Databricks	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	**16**
LSEG	1	2	1	1	2	2	2	1	**12**
FactSet	2	2	0	0	2	1	2	0	**9**
MSCI	0	0	0	0	0	0	2	0	**2**

For the AI connector score: 2 means a connector that outside AI tools can use, such as an MCP server. 1 means one announced or in limited release. 0 means none, or an assistant that works only inside the vendor's own platform.

Source: my test of each platform's public pages[13, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40], no accounts or payments, October 8, 2026. Bloomberg, Clearwater and MSCI may score lower than they deserve, because some of their pages blocked automated access.

Exhibit 7 puts Studio beside 10 platforms that a Studio buyer also deals with[33, 34, 35]. It scores each on eight things a developer with no client relationship can reach, from 0 to 2, so the total sums eight scores and runs from 0 to 16. A high total means the vendor opens to developers before any sale; a low total means access follows a relationship. So the total measures each vendor's selling model. Investment platforms cluster low because they gate. At Aladdin, as at Bloomberg, State Street, SimCorp, Clearwater and Arcesium, documentation, a sandbox and a first call come after a relationship exists. Data and cloud platforms sell to developers directly and cluster high. Among the investment platforms, only Studio offers an open-source SDK[23].

I pulled 128 recordings for this document[30, 31]. Five BlackRock speakers define Studio in them. Exhibit 8 lists each speaker with the title the recording gives.

Exhibit 8. Five BlackRock executives have defined Studio on the record, and the head of Studio engineering gave the three-part definition in November 2025

Speaker	Title, as given	What each adds to the definition	Where
Dave Woodhead	Managing Director and Head of Engineering for Aladdin Studio	The three-part definition quoted in Part 1; 3,000 internal citizen developers (a figure Goel also gives)	Snowflake podcast, November 2025[5]
Richard Newman	General Manager, Aladdin Studio	Data Cloud is "part of Studio"; analytics APIs "releasing soon … all part of the Studio umbrella"	Never Done, January 2025[15]
Diwakar Goel	Global Head of Data, Aladdin	Every transaction "via an event, via an API"; Data Cloud "within 15 minutes of latency"	Pensions webinar, 2025[26]

Speaker	Title, as given	What each adds to the definition	Where
Kunal Khara	Managing Director and Global Head of Aladdin Product	"The Aladdin studio estate" as a 2024 focus: programmatic access "at machine scale"	Awards interview, early 2024[41]
Jeff Miller	Managing Director, Global Head of Data Platform and Product Engineering	Data Cloud replaced "flat files … FTP and related transfers"	Snowflake video, undated[42]

Source: the recordings cited in the Where column. Quotations are verbatim from the transcripts; three of the five are machine transcriptions, marked as such in the Sources section at the end of this document.

Four of the five describe Studio with the same three parts. Woodhead names them outright[5]. Newman calls Data Cloud "part of Studio"[15]. Goel describes events, APIs and a near-real-time data store[26]. Khara calls it programmatic access to data and reporting[41]. A 2026 job posting calls Studio "Aladdin's extensibility layer"[43]. The message is consistent across speakers and years, so BlackRock already has a positioning for Studio. Learning about it from outside takes effort. The catalog has to be unpacked from packages. The definitions have to be transcribed from recordings. Nothing can be run.

Exhibit 9. All four speakers name APIs and events and the Data Cloud; only Goel and Woodhead name developer tools

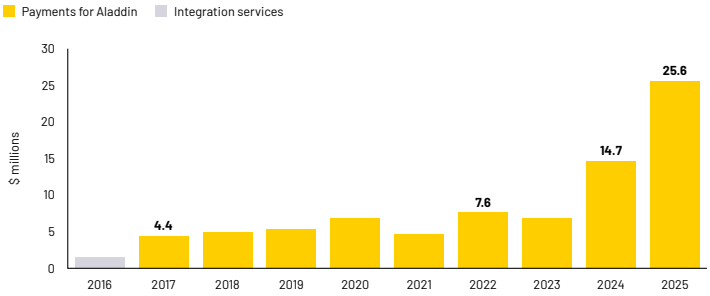
Speaker, date	What they said	APIs and events	Data Cloud	Developer tools
Kunal Khara, early 2024	"More users are craving this ability to interact with our data, with their data, with reporting with dashboards on a programmatic basis"[41]	**Yes**	**Yes**	–
Richard Newman, January 2025	"The Aladdin data cloud … which is part of Studio"; "those analytic APIs … That's all part of the Studio umbrella"[15]	**Yes**	**Yes**	–
Diwakar Goel, 2025	"Every single transaction … via an event, via an API"; "a near real time data store"; exposing "the software and application that we're building"[26]	**Yes**	**Yes**	**Yes**
Dave Woodhead, November 2025	"It exposes everything Aladdin knows how to do as a set of APIs events. The Aladdin data cloud built on top of Snowflake … developer tools"[5]	**Yes**	**Yes**	**Yes**

Source: the four recordings cited[41, 15, 26, 5]. Quotations are verbatim; Khara, Goel and Woodhead are machine or auto-caption transcriptions, marked as such in the Sources section at the end of this document. – means the speaker does not name that part.

1. Public proof that clients use Aladdin already exists, and it can serve as Studio proof even though none of it names Studio

BlackRock's Studio page names no client building on Studio[13], and a full-text search of SEC EDGAR finds no filing that mentions Studio[44]. Proof that clients use Aladdin, though, is public. On BlackRock's video, Royal London's chief executive credits Aladdin's Snowflake implementation[45]. JPMorgan Chase's proxy statements report Aladdin payments of $4.4 million to $7.6 million a year from 2017 to 2023, then $14.7 million in 2024 and $25.6 million in 2025[2, 3].

Exhibit 10. JPMorgan Chase paid BlackRock under $8 million a year for Aladdin from 2017 to 2023, then $14.7 million in 2024 and $25.6 million in 2025



Source: JPMorgan Chase proxy statements (DEF 14A), filed 2017 to 2026, by year of payment[2, 3]. The grey 2016 bar is a payment for integration services; the figures in the text start with 2017. The payments may cover more than a client license: JPMorgan is also a custodian. In 2016 it said it was connecting to Aladdin for custody clients[46]. That 2016 report is trade press, not a JPMorgan or BlackRock document.

In December 2025 a Janus Henderson engineer submitted two changes to the open-source SDK: URL rewriting and custom headers, both for firms that route Aladdin calls through an enterprise gateway. The BlackRock engineer who co-wrote the SDK's launch post merged them. The commits name a janushenderson.com address as the author[32, 47, 48, 49]. Janus Henderson's 10-K says that in the third quarter of 2025 the firm chose to move its investment management system to Aladdin, "a complex, multi-year initiative"[50]. Public buyers add a third kind of record: procurement notices that show how the bids for Aladdin were scored.

Exhibit 11. Three public pension bodies scored Aladdin bids between 2017 and 2025, and Aladdin won every one

Buyer	Year	How bids were weighted or run	Outcome
UK Pension Protection Fund[51]	2025	Technical 85, price 6, price sensitivity 6, contract terms 3	Aladdin won both lots, at a price above the fund's own estimate
Nest (UK)[52]	2023	Quality 70, cost 20, social value 10	Aladdin won against six other bids
US Pension Benefit Guaranty Corporation[53]	2017 and 2023	Full and open competition, four bids each time	Aladdin won in 2017 and again in 2023; the 2023 rebid kept the same price

Source: UK Find a Tender[51, 52]; USAspending.gov[53].

None of this proof names Studio, which matters less than it seems. Studio is sold for building custom applications on Aladdin, so a buyer wants to know that another institution built on the platform and stayed. Proof from one firm counts even when the buyer is a different kind of firm. Public pension funds, and firms whose filings or tenders already name BlackRock, are easier to name in public, so they are the natural first candidates for a named Studio story.

What this finding suggests about direction. Adoption is growing among client types whose records are public: between 2023 and 2025, a bank's proxy statement, an asset manager's 10-K and three public pension buyers' notices all record Aladdin. Named proof for Studio can start where the relationship is already on the record.

2. BlackRock tells investors growth will come from API calls and the whole portfolio. Both run through Studio, though BlackRock rarely says the name

BlackRock projected at its 2025 Investor Day that API calls across BlackRock and Aladdin would grow 17x by 2030[1]. That was the fastest-growing measure on the slide, which was about keeping the cost of growth low. Model portfolios were projected at 4x, portfolios at 2x and trade allocations at 1.3x. The slide gives no starting number and does not say which products generate the API calls. Attributing them to Studio is my inference[1]. I make that inference because API use is the activity the Studio page describes[13]. No executive said "Studio" on any of the 26 earnings calls from the first quarter of 2020 to the second quarter of 2026[4]. Outside the calls, the only investor-facing mention I found is a single line on a 2023 Investor Day slide[54]. BlackRock's 10-K says technology services fees are generally set by the value of positions on the platform or at a fixed rate. They can also depend on subscriptions, go-lives and support. The 10-K does not list API calls among the fee terms it names[10, 1].

Exhibit 12. On 26 earnings calls from Q1 2020 to Q2 2026, no BlackRock executive said "Studio", "citizen developer" or "agent"; Data Cloud, API and Copilot came up about four times in total

Term	Mentions	Context
Studio	**0**	**Never on a call. The only investor-facing mention found is one line on a 2023 Investor Day slide[54]**
Data Cloud	2	Q3 2022[55] and Q4 2024[56], described as an add-on sold with Aladdin Enterprise
API	1	Q4 2021: "clients are really looking to use both data and APIs"[57]
Copilot	1	Q4 2023: "investments in Aladdin AI copilots"[58]
Citizen developer	0	Never
Agent	0	Never

Source: third-party transcripts of BlackRock earnings calls, Q1 2020 to Q2 2026[4]. My tally. A zero means the term appears in no transcript; the non-zero counts are approximate.

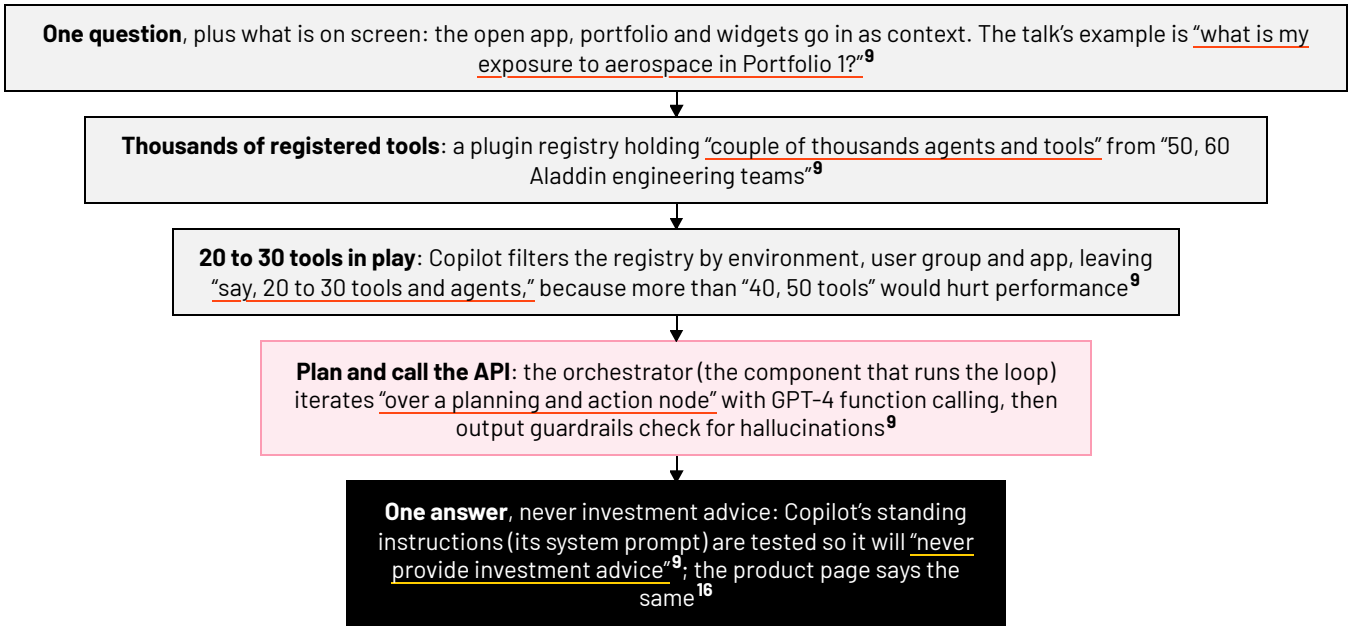
The other half of the growth story is the whole portfolio, public and private markets together. BlackRock bought eFront in 2019 and Preqin in 2025. In September 2025 its private markets team described the result on a client webinar[6]. Investors "now have access to over 15,000 fund investments within eFront Insight" for benchmarking. Preqin indices "are also available today in Aladdin Explore and our Aladdin Data Cloud capabilities". And "over 10 different transaction types" were added to Aladdin, covering commitments, fundings, paydowns and PIK, so private credit loans are captured natively. The team said those were designed with BlackRock's own professionals and "our new colleagues from HPS"[6]. Private credit analytics on Preqin followed in May 2026[12]. Newman, the Studio general manager, names eFront data and Preqin among the data being added to Data Cloud[15]. Hosting has moved to the public cloud as well. Microsoft wrote in December 2024 that all BlackRock's technology platform clients and services are hosted in the Azure cloud, with new rollouts taking "weeks instead of quarters"[25]. In December 2025 BlackRock and AWS announced a second option, with general availability for US-hosted Aladdin Enterprise clients expected in the second half of 2026[14].

What this finding suggests about direction. BlackRock itself says growth will come from extensibility and data access. The fastest-growing measure it showed investors is API calls. The data it is adding, private markets and Preqin, arrives through Data Cloud and Explore, the surfaces Studio provides. So Studio carries the growth story even when BlackRock does not say its name.

3. BlackRock keeps its AI front door inside the platform; data providers market theirs outside

Aladdin Copilot is "now available to all Aladdin clients" and "will not give investment advice or respond to questions outside Aladdin platform boundaries"[16]. Two of its engineers, Brennan Rosales, AI Engineering Lead, and Pedro Vicente Valdez, Principal AI Engineer, describe how it works. Copilot draws on a registry of plugins, "couple of thousands agents and tools," built by Aladdin's engineering teams. The first way a team adds a tool is "to define a tool as kind of mapping one-to-one to an existing Aladdin API already out in production"[9]. So Copilot's tools are Studio's APIs. Microsoft's Adrian Crockett made the dependence plain on BlackRock's podcast: "There's no copilot without plug-ins"[59]. On the data side, BlackRock's AI product head says the team is making sure "the data model itself is structured for agentic use cases"[60].

Exhibit 13. Copilot answers a question by choosing from thousands of registered tools and calling production Aladdin APIs, never giving investment advice



Source: Rosales and Valdez at LangChain Interrupt 2025[9]; the Copilot page[16]. The tool counts are the speakers' own approximations; the talk is a machine transcription, marked as such in the Sources section.

Outside the login, data providers have chosen the opposite design: they let the buyer's own AI tools reach their data. MCP is the common standard AI assistants use to pull data from other systems[61]. Six data and cloud providers that Studio buyers also use offer a connector or an MCP server, and two system-of-record rivals have announced AI features. LSEG had 90 customers connected by April 2026, according to a secondary summary of its results slides[62, 63].

I found no public connector for Aladdin on BlackRock's pages or GitHub[13, 64]. One public hint is a job advert: a Forward Deploy Engineer posting for Aladdin Data names "Model Context Protocol (MCP), AI agents, and Copilot extensions"[65]. Exhibit 14 lists both comparisons a Studio buyer makes: the system-of-record rivals and the data vendors.

Exhibit 14. Two system-of-record rivals have announced AI features; the data and cloud providers have shipped or announced AI access to their data; Aladdin has only a job advert that mentions MCP

Provider	What is public	Receipt
System-of-record rivals		
SimCorp	Agent Launchpad, announced 2026: prebuilt AI agents, and clients can build their own on SimCorp One's data layer	SimCorp news[38]
Arcesium	AI features in Aquata, and an AI platform announcement	Arcesium press releases[66, 39]
Data and cloud providers		
FactSet	An MCP server for its data, which FactSet calls the first in its market	FactSet press release[7]
LSEG	A collaboration with Anthropic and an MCP server; 90 customers connected by April 2026	LSEG press release[63]; Investing.com summary[62]
MSCI	"AI connectors" to its proprietary data	MSCI press release[40]
S&P Global	Credit Ratings added to its AI Data Portal, September 2026	S&P Global press release[67]
Snowflake	A documented MCP server for Cortex Agents	Snowflake documentation[68]
Databricks	Managed MCP servers, documented	Databricks documentation[69]
Aladdin	**None found. A Forward Deploy Engineer posting for Aladdin Data names "Model Context Protocol (MCP), AI agents, and Copilot extensions"**	**BlackRock Careers[65]**

■ Source: the press releases, documentation and job posting in the Receipt column, as of October 2026. The LSEG customer count is from a secondary summary[62]. Among system-of-record rivals, only SimCorp and Arcesium have an AI announcement in my sources; State Street, Clearwater and Bloomberg have none in my sources, so they are not listed.

Exhibit 15. Inside the login buys governance; outside the login buys discoverability on rivals' terms

	Inside the login: Copilot plugins on production APIs	Outside the login: a connector or MCP server for the buyer's own AI tools
For	Governance in one place; users keep their Aladdin permissions ("permission-dependent access"); guardrails against advice, tested in the system prompt; enterprise trust; a rollout BlackRock controls, team by team[16, 9]	Prospects can find it; developers adopt it on their own; it signals an ecosystem; a ready answer to the RFP question about connectors; and it matches what FactSet, LSEG and MSCI now offer, the comparison buyers make[7, 63, 40, 8]
Against	Prospects cannot see it, and nor can the AI tools that buyers already run; rivals set the terms of comparison; the only public description of the plugin model is one conference talk[9]	More to secure and more to support; buyers would read a partial catalog as the whole catalog; and the regulatory optics of outside AI tools drawing on a platform that will not give advice[16]

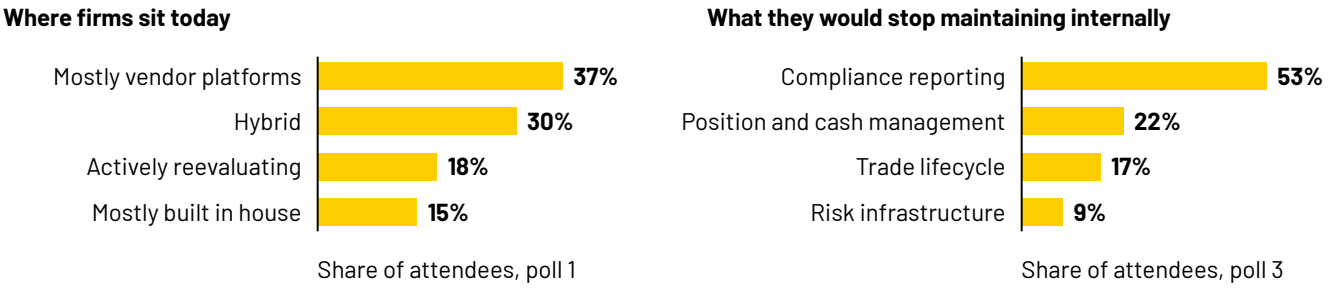
■ Source: my reading of the Copilot page[16], the LangChain talk[9], the provider announcements in Exhibit 14 and the Build vs. Buy webinar[8].

> **What this finding suggests about direction.** I would describe the Copilot plugin model publicly now. Copilot's tools are production Aladdin APIs, the same governed APIs Studio exposes. Copilot inherits each user's permissions. Its no-advice guardrails are tested in the system prompt, and it never gives investment advice[9, 16]. Said in BlackRock's own words, that description answers the RFP connector question better than an MCP server with a partial catalog. It also lets BlackRock, not FactSet and LSEG, set the terms of comparison. I would hold any outside connector for now. The inside model already answers three governance questions: who can call what, with which permissions, and under which guardrails. An outside connector should wait until those are answered for outside callers. Exhibit 15 is the evidence; this is the fifth direction in Part 3.

4. Buyers at BlackRock's own webinar said they want a core platform plus their own builds, and rivals are already selling to those buyers

BlackRock ran a Build vs. Buy webinar for asset managers and polled the attendees. The first poll asked where firms sit today. 37 percent said they run "mostly vendor platforms," 30 percent run a "hybrid," 18 percent are "actively reevaluating," and 15 percent are "mostly built in house"[8]. The second poll asked what is driving the build-or-buy decision. "AI and data demands" led at 42 percent; cost and speed to market tied for second[8]. The third poll asked what they would stop maintaining in house. 53 percent chose compliance reporting[8]. The host read out a slide saying that 60 to 70 percent of technology cost sits in "maintenance of current systems"[8]. Clark Schafer of Alpha FMC, the panelist, said a transformation runs "roughly 12 to 18 months"[8].

Exhibit 16. Attendees of BlackRock's Build vs. Buy webinar mostly run vendor or hybrid platforms, and compliance reporting is the first thing they would stop maintaining



Source: poll results as read out on the Build vs. Buy webinar replay, taken from the published captions[8]. The webinar did not state attendee counts. Poll 2, which is not charted, asked what is driving the decision: "AI and data demands" led at 42 percent, and cost and speed to market tied for second.

> "What's the API suite that you have? Are you using connectors to Snowflake or to Databricks? And I think that that part of the RFP has become much more prominent."
>
> — Clark Schafer, Partner, Alpha FMC, on the Build vs. Buy webinar[8]

Alisha Sewdass, BlackRock's Head of Aladdin Solutions Engineering, Americas, gave BlackRock's side on the same webinar. "That word monolith is definitely being challenged in the market," she said. The shift of the last two years is "to more of a modular approach where clients are looking for that backbone foundational data that supports both publics and privates workflows." That comes, she said, with "very, very robust APIs that manage the end to end life cycle of a transaction," so that clients can build "their secret sauce rebalancing tools" on top[8]. On AI, she said, "you need that system of record that underpins anything that AI is built upon," and "the other layer that is almost equally important is a really defined system of work"[8].

Rivals are selling to the same buyer, the one who wants a core platform plus their own builds. SimCorp announced wins at AllianceBernstein in February 2026 and Pictet in May 2026. AllianceBernstein keeps its "specialized in-house technology," and Pictet connects its own tools to SimCorp One by API[70, 71]. BlackRock's own August 2026 insight page says the same: "Build vs buy is no longer a binary question"[72].

> **What this finding suggests about direction.** Buyers now ask in RFPs whether they can build on the platform. Studio is the right kind of answer: the APIs, events and Data Cloud that Sewdass describes are the pieces in Exhibit 4. It is not yet a finished answer: the public catalog in Part 1 is mostly alpha, and the SDK is beta. The directions in Part 3 put Studio into the RFP, where the buyer is asking.

What would change my view

Each finding rests on public facts, so a public fact could overturn it. I would revise:

- Finding 1, if BlackRock published a named Studio client story, or an SEC filing mentioned Studio.
- Finding 2, if a BlackRock earnings call or investor deck named Studio.
- Finding 2 again, if a slide attributed the API-call growth to specific products.
- Finding 3, if a public Aladdin MCP server or connector appeared on BlackRock's pages or GitHub.
- Finding 4, if a published attendee count showed the Build vs. Buy polls were small.

Part 3

Where the research points this role's first six months

Part 1 and the four findings point to six likely initial directions. They are not a plan; Exhibit 18 lists what I would need from inside before sizing any of them. Each direction passes three tests. It uses only what is already public, or already true inside BlackRock. It works inside the enterprise selling model described in Part 1. And it changes nothing about what a prospect can access. Product owns what is built and when; marketing owns positioning, stories and sales material; compliance checks the final version.

Exhibit 17. Six likely initial directions, each resting on a public fact, with an owner and a way to know it worked

Direction	Why (finding)	What it involves	Owner	How I would know it worked
A named proof program, starting with clients whose Aladdin relationship is already public	Finding 1	Shortlist clients already on the record. Public funds whose tenders BlackRock won: the Pension Protection Fund, Nest, PBGC. SEC filers that disclose Aladdin: JPMorgan Chase, Janus Henderson. And Royal London, already on video[51, 3, 50, 45]. Ask each for one sentence about Studio, or one thing they built on it. Accept proof from a firm unlike the prospect; a pension fund's story still serves an insurer	Marketing, with the client business for introductions	Number of named references in use by sales; number of deals in which one was cited
Studio's name on the API growth story	Finding 2	Agree with investor relations and product on one measure of API use, starting from the API-call projection[1] already shown to investors. Then put Studio's name beside that measure in investor and client materials	Product with investor relations; marketing writes the story	Studio named beside the measure in the next investor and client decks
A written one-page version of the definition BlackRock's speakers already give	Part 1	Turn the definition four speakers already give[5, 15, 26, 41] into one written page. Have product and compliance review it. Use it in every deck and page	Marketing	One page adopted; no deck or page that contradicts it

Direction	Why (finding)	What it involves	Owner	How I would know it worked
An RFP-ready "API suite" answer for qualified buyers	Finding 4	A document that answers the question Schafer says buyers now ask[8]. It lists the API domains, the specification and operation counts and status for each, the Snowflake and Databricks connectors, and how clients build on top. The solutions team delivers it once a prospect is qualified	Solutions engineering, with marketing	Time to answer the API question in an RFP; RFPs in which it is used
Publish a description of the Copilot plugin model	Finding 3	One page, in BlackRock's words, that opens no new access. It says how Copilot's tools map to production APIs[9], what governance applies[16], and how clients will connect their own AI tools. Publish the plugin-model and governance parts now; add the client AI-tool section when the work described in the Forward Deploy Engineer posting[65] is ready	Product with marketing; compliance review	The description is public and dated; prospects stop asking about connectors in deal reviews
A prospect-facing "what is in the box" summary	Part 1	One page listing the 11 API domains with the count and status of each, as in Exhibit 5[17], but without the specifications themselves. Share it before the first meeting, or put it on the Studio page	Marketing, with product	First meetings that skip the what-is-included discussion; prospects who arrive already holding the list

■ Source: my proposals, built on Part 1 and Findings 1 to 4. Receipts in the table point to the public facts each direction rests on.

What I would need from inside

Five questions need internal data that no public source holds. The answers would confirm or correct the findings before anyone puts a number on a direction. They are also where any error in my reading would show first.

Exhibit 18. Five questions only internal data can answer, and what each answer would decide

Question	What the answer would decide
How many clients have active API credentials or a Data Cloud instance, and how has that changed since 2024?	The baseline for every measure in Exhibit 17
Which clients would agree to be named, and what usually stops them?	How soon the named proof program can start
What does the `Access.Internal` tag on every public specification mean, and does it limit what can be described without a login?	What the "what is in the box" summary may say
How will clients connect their own AI tools to Aladdin, and is the Forward Deploy Engineer work how they will do it?	The timing of the Copilot description
Where does adoption stall most: awareness, the first API call, or getting a build into production?	Where marketing spends first: content, sales enablement or client success

■ Source: my questions. Question 3 refers to the tag on the public specifications[17]; question 4 to the job posting that names MCP[65].

About this document

This is an independent analysis compiled from public sources: BlackRock product pages, SEC filings, procurement notices, public code and packages on GitHub and PyPI, press releases, job postings, and transcripts of BlackRock recordings. BlackRock did not produce, review or endorse it.

AI agents pulled the pages, unpacked the packages, transcribed the recordings and drafted the text. I checked each claim against the document or recording it cites.

Facts are as of October 19, 2026, unless an exhibit gives another date. Underlined text links to the document behind each fact. Superscripts point to the Sources section, which follows this page and gives the grade, the title, the speaker and the date of every source.

The directions and questions in Part 3 are my proposals, based on Part 1 and the findings in Part 2.

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Sources

Sources are numbered in the order they are first cited, then grouped by grade, so the numbers within a group are not consecutive. P is a primary document. S is a BlackRock speaker on the record, with name and title as the recording gives them. T is a third-party report. For recordings, each entry gives the minute and second at which each quoted passage begins. "Machine transcription" means a local transcription of the downloaded audio. "Auto-captions" means YouTube's captions. Both can mishear names and jargon. Inside quotations, the only correction made was to the spelling of proper names the captions got wrong.

P. Primary documents

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8 **S** **Build vs. buy: how asset managers are rethinking key decisions (webinar replay; published captions)**. Michael Campos, US asset manager coverage, and Alisha Sewdass, Head of Aladdin Solutions Engineering, Americas, BlackRock, with Clark Schafer, Partner, Alpha FMC, replay page undated. https://www.blackrock.com/aladdin/discover/expertise/webinars/build-vs-buy-how-asset-managers-are-rethinking-key-decisions Quoted at 4:37, 4:40, 14:46, 24:34, 31:56, 32:01, 39:15, 39:42, 42:22, 47:41 (Sewdass at 31:56, 32:01, 39:15 and 39:42; Schafer at 42:22).

9 **S** **How BlackRock built production AI agents for asset management with LangGraph (LangChain Interrupt 2025; machine transcription)**. Brennan Rosales, AI Engineering Lead, and Pedro Vicente Valdez, Principal AI Engineer, BlackRock, 2025. https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=oyqeCHFM5U4 Quoted at 1:33, 1:44, 1:53, 3:58, 4:31, 5:27, 6:42, 7:16, 7:22, 7:34, 10:30.

15 **S** **Data: the key ingredient (Never Done podcast, with Snowflake; published transcript)**. Richard Newman, General Manager, Aladdin Studio, BlackRock, January 8, 2025. https://www.blackrock.com/aladdin/discover/podcast/snowflake-podcast-data-the-key-ingredient Quoted at 0:23, 1:32, 1:54, 2:00.

20 **S** **How can tech transform numbers into insightful narratives? (Big Little Questions, Aladdin Accounting episode; machine transcription)**. David Schneid and Daniel Shannon, Aladdin Accounting, BlackRock, undated; the recording does not label which of the two is speaking. https://www.blackrock.com/aladdin/discover/expertise/big-little-questions Quoted at 0:32, 1:05, 1:23.

26 **S** **Data as a strategic asset for pensions (webinar replay; machine transcription)**. Diwakar Goel, Global Head of Data, Aladdin, BlackRock, 2025, page undated. https://www.blackrock.com/aladdin/discover/expertise/webinars/data-as-a-strategic-assets-for-pensions Quoted at 25:22, 28:52, 29:28, 29:37. Goel also gives the 3,000 citizen-developer figure, at 35:23; Exhibit 8 credits it to Woodhead, who gives it at 9:39 in entry 5.

41 **S** **Best Overall Technology Provider for 2023, Buy-Side Technology Awards winner interview (machine transcription)**. Kunal Khara, Managing Director and Global Head of Aladdin Product, BlackRock, early 2024. https://www.blackrock.com/aladdin/discover (hub page; the interview video is reached from it). Quoted at 18:37, 18:42, 18:48.

42 **S** **BlackRock transforms client data delivery with Snowflake's Aladdin Data Cloud (Snowflake video; machine transcription)**. Jeff Miller, Managing Director, Global Head of Data Platform and Product Engineering, BlackRock, undated. https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=3iXd7a7_F6g Quoted at 0:36.

45 S **Shaping tomorrow with technology (Aladdin client story video; machine transcription)**. Hans Georgeson, Chief Executive, Royal London Asset Management, with Tarek Chouman, Global Head of the Aladdin Client Business, recorded November 2024. https://www.blackrock.com/aladdin/discover/client-story/client-testimonial-royal-london-asset-management Not quoted; the Snowflake passage referred to begins at 5:21.

59 S **Humans in the loop, robots on the team, part 2 (Never Done podcast; published transcript)**. Adrian Crockett, General Manager, Microsoft Cloud for Financial Services, with Syril Smith Garson, Head of Product for AI, BlackRock, November 6, 2024. https://www.blackrock.com/aladdin/discover/podcast/microsoft-part-2-podcast Quoted at 8:00 (Smith Garson), 17:29 (Crockett).

60 S **Reducing time to insight: how AI reshapes risk management (Never Done podcast; machine transcription)**. Pavan Pemmaraju, Head of AI Product and Engineering, BlackRock, July 16, 2026. https://www.blackrock.com/aladdin/discover/podcast/reducing-time-to-insight-how-ai-is-reshaping-risk-management Quoted at 10:00, 17:37. The episode also features Jess Fitzgibbon, Head of Product for Aladdin Risk; the recording does not label speakers, so the 10:00 passage is not attributed to either by name in this document.

T. Third-party reports

4 T **BlackRock earnings call transcripts, Q1 2020 to Q2 2026**. roic.ai, 2020 to 2026. https://www.roic.ai/quote/BLK/transcripts

21 T **Blackrock Aladdin Explore: Intro (an Aladdin classroom session; third-party YouTube upload; machine transcription)**. Uploaded by the channel "jas jas," speaker not named, undated. https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BahCi45_BTc Quoted at 6:26, 9:34.

46 T **JP Morgan to connect to BlackRock's Aladdin**. The TRADE, 2016. https://www.thetradenews.com/jp-morgan-to-connect-to-blackrocks-aladdin/

55 T **BlackRock Q3 2022 earnings call transcript**. roic.ai, October 2022. https://www.roic.ai/quote/BLK/transcripts/2022-year/3-quarter

56 T **BlackRock Q4 2024 earnings call transcript**. roic.ai, January 2025. https://www.roic.ai/quote/BLK/transcripts/2024-year/4-quarter

57 T **BlackRock Q4 2021 earnings call transcript**. roic.ai, January 2022. https://www.roic.ai/quote/BLK/transcripts/2021-year/4-quarter

58 T **BlackRock Q4 2023 earnings call transcript**. roic.ai, January 2024. https://www.roic.ai/quote/BLK/transcripts/2023-year/4-quarter

62 T **LSEG Q1 2026 slides: record growth, AI adoption accelerates (summary of LSEG results slides)**. Investing.com, April 2026. https://www.investing.com/news/company-news/lseg-q1-2026-slides-record-growth-ai-adoption-accelerates-93CH-4631412